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ACADEMIC VAULT

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Cybersecurity and Online Safety: Protect Your Accounts, Data and Future

Practical account security, phishing defence and the legal risks of cybercrime

DIGITAL SKILLS

Digital Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Students are targeted because they hold bank details, social accounts and personal data with limited security habits. This pack covers strong authentication, phishing recognition, device hygiene and the Nigerian legal consequences of offences such as identity theft and unauthorised access.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Secure accounts with strong passwords and two-factor authentication.
- Recognise phishing messages and verify links before clicking.
- Apply device and data hygiene practices.
- Explain the legal consequences of common cybercrimes in Nigeria.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Account security

Most account compromise comes from reused passwords and social engineering, not sophisticated hacking.

- Use a unique passphrase for every important account.
- Enable two-factor authentication, preferably an authenticator app over SMS.
- Never share one-time passwords, even with someone claiming to be support.
- Review connected apps and revoke access you do not recognise.
- Lock your phone and laptop with a PIN or biometric, and encrypt if available.

- Log out of shared computers and never save passwords on public devices.

Phishing and social engineering

Attackers persuade; they rarely need to break in.

- Check the sender address, not just the display name.
- Hover over links to see the real destination before clicking.
- Be suspicious of urgency, threats, and requests for codes or payments.
- Verify unusual requests through a second channel you initiate.
- Treat attachments from unknown senders as dangerous.
- Report phishing to the platform and delete it; do not forward it.

> **The OTP rule**
> No bank, university or platform will ask for your OTP. Anyone who does is committing fraud, regardless of how official they sound.

Device hygiene and the law

Digital habits have legal and reputational consequences.

- Update operating systems and apps; updates patch known vulnerabilities.
- Back up important files to two locations.
- Avoid cracked software, which often carries malware.
- Do not use another person's credentials or access systems without authorisation.
- Under the Cybercrimes Act, offences include unauthorised access, identity theft, cyberstalking and phishing, with serious penalties.
- Online behaviour is permanent; screenshots and logs outlive deletion.

The threats that actually reach students

Most online harm comes through a handful of routes: phishing messages that steal passwords, fraudulent payment requests, account takeover through reused passwords, sextortion using stolen images, malware from pirated software, and identity misuse of photographs and documents.

Cybercrime is also something students can commit without realising it: using someone else's account, accessing a system without permission, sharing pirated material, or forwarding intimate images. In Nigeria these are criminal offences with real penalties, and "I did not know" is not a defence.

The common thread in victimisation is urgency. Fraud works by making you act before you think. Any message demanding immediate action - pay now, verify now, send the code now - is a reason to slow down, not to hurry.

Habits that prevent most incidents